

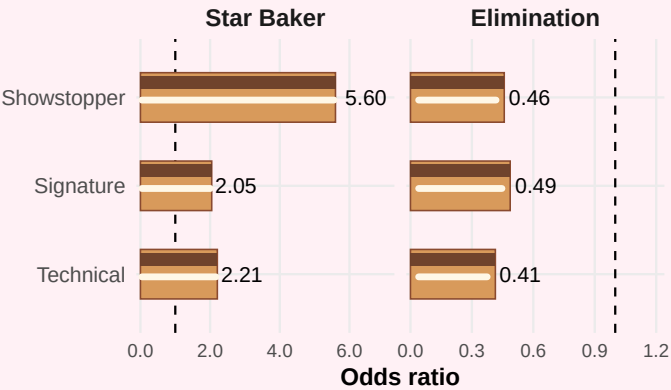
Great British Bake Off: What Really Matters in the Tent?

Does what matters for winning Star Baker differ from what matters for avoiding elimination? Who were the strongest bakers?

Netflix-era data: 9 series · 90 episodes · 108 bakers

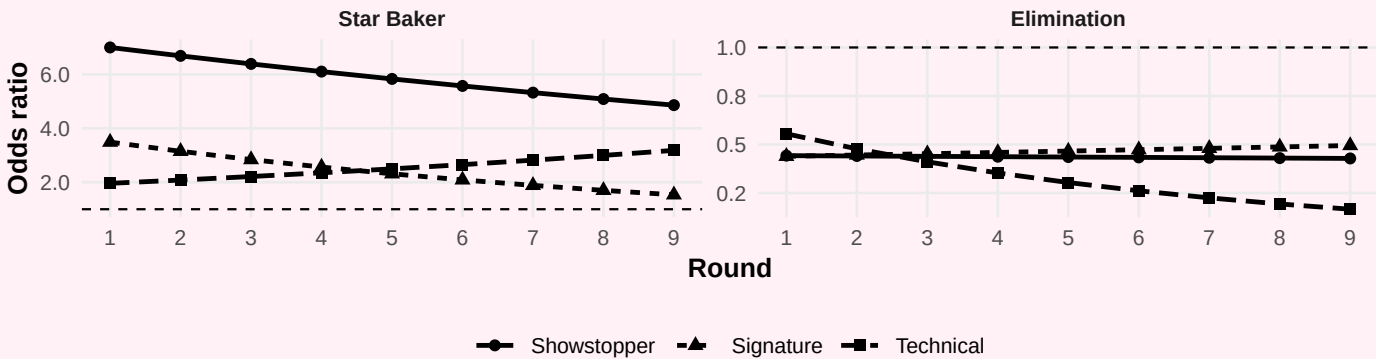
Main effects

Not allowing changing effects by round (unrealistic)



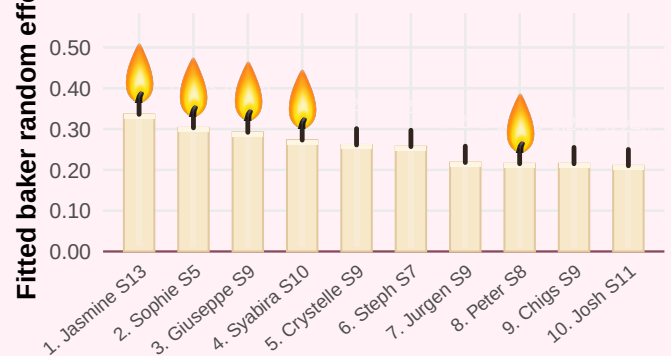
Round-interacted effects

Showing how effects change over the rounds: +1 Sig./Showstopper point (-3 to 3); 2-rank Tech improvement



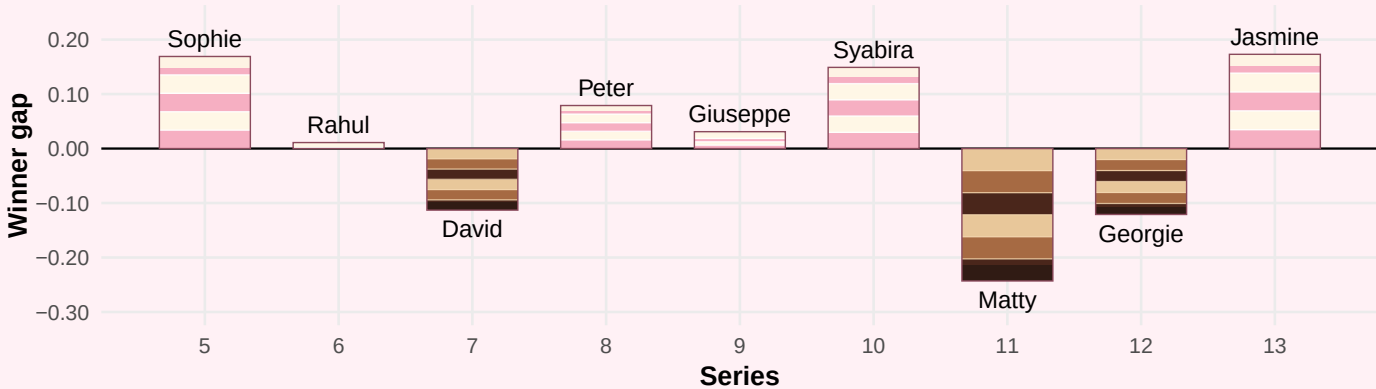
Top fitted baker effects

Season-long fitted strength as candles; winners are lit



Did the winner look strongest all season (were they top fitted)?

Winner minus best non-winner fitted baker effect



The Bake Off Recipe (for Contestants)

1. Star Baker

Showstopper matters most.

2. Avoiding Elimination

Technical matters more later.

3. Winning the Final

Season-long strength helps, but finale performance — especially the Showstopper — can decide the winner.